Reasons for Conservation

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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Written by: Phil
Reviewed by: Lára Marie McIvor
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Reasons for Conservation: Extended

Extended Tier Only

- There are numerous reasons why **conservation programmes are important**
  - Maintaining or increasing biodiversity
    - Which allows ecosystems to remain stable
  - Reducing extinction
    - Helps to retain iconic species and maintain biodiversity
  - Protecting vulnerable ecosystems which would have been quickly lost to human activity
  - Maintaining ecosystem functions
    - Nutrient cycling eg. carbon cycling to hold back climate change
    - Resource provision, such as
      - Food - making sure we have enough for the population
      - Drugs - having access to plants for plant-based remedies
      - Fuel - for improtant activities such as cooking
      - Genes - so the gene pool remains wide and variety exists in all species

Conservation Techniques: Extended

Extended Tier Only

- Certain conservation techniques can be used to **maintain biodiversity**
- Examples include
  - **Artificial insemination** (AI) in captive breeding programmes
    - This process involves inserting sperm from a male into the reproductive tract of a female, e.g. using a syringe

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Got it

animals
    - **In vitro fertilisation** (IVF) in captive breeding programmes
        - IVF involves using sperm to fertilise egg cells in a lab; the resulting fertilised egg cell can then be implanted into a female for development
        - This allows gametes with **known alleles** to be used, ensuring that the next generation remains genetically diverse

Risks to a species

- If its population size decreases, a species will experience **reduced genetic variation**
- This renders the species **more susceptible** to environmental change
- The species is **less resilient** and has a greater **risk of extinction**

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